3.3 Pillar 3: Build enabling capability

Pillar 3 decides whether the other two can be delivered and shared: who benefits, who pays, who decides and who measures.

The December tree asked the pillar to build an inclusive, well-governed tourism system that supports sustainable growth, returns and development (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64). The evidence found each part of that system thin.

- **Inclusion.** Twenty township and rural communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive a traced 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5).
- **Investment.** The capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads and rail, and none of it reaches tourism product, bookability or community assets (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p32 to p87, p100, p112).
- **Governance.** Visas and air service agreements sit with national government, and mobility mandates are split across three tiers (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58; Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23).
- **Measurement.** No approved methodology exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p37).

This pillar changed most between December and October, and now holds eight focus areas. The inclusion entry was refined and held at concept level. Sustainability was reworded to climate risk and local destination funding, and institutional review to three-tier alignment. The deficits entry moved in from Pillar 2, and workforce skills was added and flagged as untested.

The evidence here is mostly qualitative. It rests on attributed stakeholder statements, the Diagnostic's one-slide tier table, the Inclusion Plan and the Infrastructure Report's gap tables, so this pillar carries more open items than the other two.

Table 3.15. Pillar 3 holds eight focus areas, the widest spread of dispositions in the tree.

Focus area	Disposition	What the evidence showed	Initiative
13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion	Refined	Organisation, not distance or product, binds in eleven of twenty communities	I12
14 Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism	Reworded	Climate already closes sites and routes; local tourism bodies depend on disrupted municipal funding	I13
15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies	Validated	No committed capital reaches tourism product, bookability or community assets	I14
16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers	Reworded	Air rights and visas sit nationally, and mandates are split across three tiers	I15
17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration	Validated	Fifteen of sixteen organisations raised collaboration, and JAMS already exists	I15
18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing	Validated	No approved provincial jobs method and no single view of the visitor	I16
19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits	Moved	The best-evidenced barriers, with most of the levers held nationally	I17
20 Develop workforce and service skills	Flagged	The jobs ambition has no baseline and no labour analysis	I18

Source: Chapter 3 entries 13 to 20. Dispositions as recorded at the 14 October 2026 review [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026, pp15 to 16: deck page reference to be confirmed].

3.3.1 Investment, inclusion and sustainability

The first enabling theme covers who benefits from growth, how it is paid for and how it lasts. It holds three focus areas: community inclusion, climate risk and investment. The inclusion entry stays at concept level, as agreed with Wesgro on 24 September 2026; roles and funding sit in Chapter 4.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 13

Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion

Twenty communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but a traced 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend, and in eleven the binding constraint is organisation, not distance or product.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Drive Community and SME Inclusion (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Refined. A seller with a stake, 20 communities and R259m at 1%. The SME and Community Inclusion Plan drove the refinement. As agreed with Wesgro on 24 September 2026, the entry stays at concept level, and roles and funding are set in Chapter 4.

Evidence

Table 3.16. The shortlisted communities sit close to visitors but earn almost nothing from them, and most lack a body that can sell.

Finding	Figure	Source
Close to demand	93 of 107 long-listed communities lie within 45 minutes of a tourism node or corridor; distance is the binding constraint in none of the 20	SCIP p16, p30
Almost no spend	18.4% of residents (Census 2011) against a traced floor of 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend, about R4m to R10m a year	SCIP p5
Organisation binds	Organisation is the binding constraint in 11 of 20 communities, and 10 have no identified active tourism body	SCIP p28, p30
Product sells by phone	No profiled community rates Ready on digital and bookability; Zwelihle's four resident guides sell by phone with no shared channel	SCIP p20 to p26, p34
Safety is a gate	9 of 20 communities record a safety-perception gap and 5 record extortion (SAPS 2025/26 station data)	SCIP p27, p30
The prize	1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend is R259m a year, about 26 to 65 times today's documented floor	SCIP p5

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP; desk research 17 to 23 September 2026, ratings from the community side with LTO confirmation outstanding). The R259m is 1% of the R25.9bn FY2025 foreign direct spend in the Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11. The plan does not describe how the spend floor was traced. The multiple of today's floor is computed.

The plan's five cases set the order of action: a seller with a stake, a safe and workable visit, product that keeps spend in the community, then exposure (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p12). Kliptown in Soweto shows the cost of the reverse order. Walter Sisulu Square cost R160 million to R180 million before an operator was in place, and drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year by 2017 against a business case of almost 200,000 international visitors (p11).

Recommendation

Wesgro should connect community product to the demand it already moves, and leave the building of selling bodies to municipalities, LTOs and the communities themselves. The plan's model has three parts: a selling capability that works, a link to demand that already exists and gates that must be passed before activation and investment (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32). Two or three pilot communities test it, and it scales only after agreed thresholds are met (p32). The plan's sequence runs from validating the offer and opening a booking route, through a safety plan and a fixed-date test, to investment after demand and scale through channels (p31).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Put pilot community product into the itineraries, calendars and channels Wesgro already runs, such as the Langa and Kayamandi routes and the Mal'va festival listing	Tourism; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Choose the two or three pilots with partners on the plan's readiness criteria, and keep the record of bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue	Research; Tourism
Partners	Form or fund a local selling body in each pilot community, with one live booking route, published dates and a named customer contact	Municipalities; LTOs; community sellers
Partners	Attach maintenance and marketing covenants to public assets before any re-letting or upgrade	Municipalities
National	Commit SAPS to the launch safety plans the pilots need, and open ACSA and other national procurement to businesses trading inside the communities	SAPS; ACSA

Benchmark precedent

Kenya writes community participation into its tourism governance and investment system through community conservancies, with benefits across rural communities among the listed outcomes (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33). The plan's own cases carry the figures: Medellín's Comuna 13 drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025 around resident-run product, while Kliptown shows what capital before an operator buys (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p8, p11).

Link forward

Initiative I12, community inclusion pilots (section 4.3), with booking routes shared with **I3** (focus area 3). **Indicators** T1-07 community share of foreign direct spend at impact level and T2-17 communities with a live booking route at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 14

Manage climate risk and sustainable tourism

Climate is already costing the province sites, routes and revenue, while the local tourism bodies that would manage the response depend on municipal funding that Treasury Circular 131 has disrupted.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Ensure Sustainable Destination Management (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Reworded. LTOs are unfunded and the Meiringspoort flood cut a route. Destination-management funding and dated climate losses replaced a general sustainability entry. The stakeholder evidence on LTO funding and climate losses drove the change, with the Inclusion Plan's De Rust profile for the flood.

Evidence

Table 3.17. Climate losses are dated and site-specific, and the bodies that manage destinations locally have no stable funding.

Finding	Figure	Source
LTOs depend on municipalities	Most local tourism bodies are not operationally sustainable without municipal funding, and Treasury Circular 131 has disrupted that route (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p25
LTO budgets go to marketing	LTO contracts and budgets are weighted toward destination marketing, leaving little for tourism development (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39
A flood cut a route	Meiringspoort closed since the flood of 6 May 2026; rebuild R421m over about 26 months; De Rust's pass-through trade cut	SCIP p24
Weather costs a flagship	Weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year, on management's estimate	SIR p33
Sites are closing	Flooding, fire and extreme heat are closing CapeNature sites and restricting trails; high winds close the Cableway for a significant part of the year	SIR p43, p36
Every district has a climate risk	Water security in the Metro and the Garden Route; drought, heat and fire in the Cape Winelands; wildflower predictability on the West Coast; whale migration and sea levels in the Overberg; summer heat in the Central Karoo	IR p31, p64, p75, p86; Diag p43, p45

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag). No deliverable quantifies climate risk province-wide.

No deliverable puts a provincial figure on tourism revenue at risk from weather or water [provincial estimate of tourism revenue at risk: none in hand], and none counts the LTOs or their grant funding [number of Western Cape LTOs and their municipal funding before and after Circular 131: DEDAT to supply]. The only working sustainability standard on record is Mossel Bay's membership inspections, which check water-wise and green practices (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p21).

Recommendation

Wesgro should treat climate as a destination-management risk it reports on and plans around, and press for stable funding of the local bodies that do the work. The deliverables diagnose this entry more than they prescribe for it. The Diagnostic asks for a climate-smart wine region, a nature-positive test bed in the Overberg and resilience investment on the Garden Route (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p43, p45, p49). CapeNature is

already reassessing asset formats and siting to cut losses from flooding, fire and extreme weather (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p43).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Keep a climate and weather risk register for tourism sites and routes, starting with the Robben Island, Cableway and CapeNature losses and the Meiringspoort closure	Research; site operators
Wesgro	Build sustainability checks into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11) on the Mossel Bay model	Tourism; LTOs
Wesgro	Route itineraries and marketing around closures, starting with alternatives to Meiringspoort until the pass reopens	Destination Marketing; Garden Route and Klein Karoo LTOs
Partners	Give LTOs a stable funding agreement with a development mandate, written into IDPs with reporting	Municipalities; district municipalities; DEDAT
Partners	Make reserve and attraction assets climate-resilient, with off-grid power at remote sites	CapeNature; site operators
National	Resolve the effect of Treasury Circular 131 on municipal funding of local tourism bodies, and complete the Meiringspoort rebuild	National Treasury; the road authority

Benchmark precedent

No benchmark case carries a climate-adaptation or local destination-body funding lever. The nearest are Kenya's tourism-funded conservation financing, a self-financing system that supports conservation and sustains demand, and Valencia's SICTED quality system with its environmental compliance frameworks (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33, p47).

Link forward

Initiative I13, climate resilience and destination management, including LTO funding (section 4.3).
Indicators T2-18 LTOs with a funding agreement and T2-19 weather losses at flagship sites at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · FOCUS AREA 15

Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies

The province has a capital pipeline for airports, ports, roads and rail, but none of it reaches tourism product, bookability, accommodation depth or community assets, which is where the growth case needs investment.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Crowd-In Capital with Targeted Investment Strategies (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. No pipeline. The Infrastructure Report's pipeline and gap-closure tables drove the disposition, with the stakeholder view that funding sits below peers and the Chilean and New Zealand benchmarks. The reason is an inference: the report lists a large capital pipeline, and its gap columns show that none of it reaches tourism product.

Evidence

Table 3.18. Capital is committed to gateways and transport, and each district's tourism gaps carry no committed capital.

Finding	Figure	Source
The Metro pipeline	About R30bn or more planned: ~R11.3bn at Cape Town International, R20bn for the V&A Granger Bay expansion and R3.3bn for MyCiTi Phase 2; SME bookability and township product sit outside every capital programme	IR p32
Airports are funded	R310m George terminal by 2028; Cape Winelands Airport ~R8bn private phase 1, with funding not yet locked in	IR p43, p106
Tourism gaps are not	No committed capital for West Coast accommodation and payments, De Hoop accommodation, Whale Coast bookability, Overberg year-round product or Route 62 accommodation	IR p65, p76, p87
Port capital is for freight	Of the port capital listed, only the R22m Mossel Bay reception facility is for cruise	IR p112
Funding is below peers	Western Cape tourism funding is materially below peer destinations, and a tourism levy and blended finance are under consideration	SIR p25, p23
Capital first fails	Kliptown's Walter Sisulu Square cost R160m to R180m before an operator and drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year by 2017	SCIP p11

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; the ~R11.3bn CTIA headline itemises to R9.94bn on p103); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP). No deliverable gives a Western Cape tourism funding-gap figure.

The instrument this entry calls for was planned and not delivered. The Inception Report scoped an investment opportunity framework that would score gaps against return, jobs and inclusion, with a roadmap of quick wins, medium-term plays and long-term moves (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p18, p20). The gap-closure tables are its input [Western Cape tourism funding against the peer set: DEDAT and Wesgro budget data needed].

Recommendation

Wesgro should build the tourism investment pipeline the gap tables imply, and commit capital only where demand has been shown. The Inclusion Plan's rule applies across the portfolio: invest after demand, and attach a maintenance and marketing covenant to any public asset (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p31,

p15). The benchmarks offer the vehicles: Chile's private concession for its gateway airport and New Zealand's route incentives tied to bookings (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p26, p54).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Build a tourism investment pipeline from the gap-closure tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion, and take it to investors	Wesgro investment promotion; Tourism; DEDAT
Wesgro	Prepare investment cases for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in secondary nodes and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62	Wesgro investment promotion; private investors
Wesgro	Set up the public-private air access fund with ring-fenced corridor budgets (focus area 7)	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector
Partners	Test a tourism levy and blended-finance vehicles for destination management and mobility	DEDAT; City of Cape Town
Partners	Attach covenants to public assets before re-letting or upgrading them, and invest in community assets only after demand is proven	Municipalities
National	Hold ACSA, PRASA and Transnet to their published capital dates, and add tourism use to the port plans	ACSA; PRASA; Transnet

Benchmark precedent

Chile funded a ~US$900 million expansion of its gateway airport through a private concession awarded by its Ministry of Public Works (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p26). Melbourne's event-led demand drew 21% growth in hotel rooms, 5,000 new rooms and the entry of global hotel brands (p18).

Link forward

Initiative I14, tourism investment pipeline (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-20 pipeline projects at financial close at outcome level (section 5.2).

3.3.2 Governance and leadership

The second enabling theme covers who decides and how the plan is run. It holds five focus areas, the most of any theme. They are three-tier alignment, industry collaboration, data and policy, the national deficits moved in from Pillar 2 and workforce skills, which was added in October and flagged as untested.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 16

Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers

Air service agreements and visas sit with national government, mandates are split across three tiers and the national marketing body is weak, so the province needs one shared agenda with clear decision rights.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Review Institutional Arrangements (Wesgro, DEDAT, CTT) (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64), reprinted from March 2026 as Review Institutional Arrangements (local, provincial and national).

October 2026: Reworded. Air rights and visas sit nationally. The review of three named bodies widened to alignment across national, provincial and local government. The stakeholder evidence on bilateral agreements and split mandates, the Diagnostic's tier table and MIDAS's account of route designation drove the change.

Evidence

Table 3.19. The levers the growth case needs are spread across three tiers, and the bodies that hold them are thin or out of step.

Finding	Figure	Source
National holds air rights and visas	The national tier holds visa rules and border compliance, and air service agreements and route rights; the province holds jobs, safety programmes and infrastructure planning	Diag p58
Bilateral agreements bind	Restrictive bilateral air agreements limit airlift and leave the province less competitive than peers (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p24
Chinese routes are state decisions	Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements, and the designated airline may learn of its designation late	MIDAS, Chinese Market Opportunity
Capacity has eroded	Tourism institutional capacity has eroded at provincial and municipal level over a decade; SA Tourism's weakness constrains otherwise sound international strategies	SIR p25
Mandates are split	Mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers; a district, local and LTO mandate disconnect leaves tourism development without a clear owner	SIR p23, p39
The capital is national	ACSA's runway (R6.39bn, about 2033), Transnet's port plans and PRASA's R21.1bn rail programme all sit with national SOEs	IR p100, p103, p112

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR). The only national government bodies with an appendix table in the first phase of engagement, Stats SA and the Department of Tourism, speak to data alone; SA Tourism has none.

What is needed, in the Diagnostic's own words, is a shared growth agenda with clear decision rights and joint delivery plans (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58). No deliverable maps decision rights by tier beyond that one slide. The national view on air rights, visas and marketing is inferred from provincial and local voices, not heard directly. The two national bodies with appendix tables, Stats SA and the Department of Tourism,

spoke only to data, and SA Tourism is listed as engaged with no table (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16, p30, p37).

Recommendation

Wesgro should convene the shared agenda and hold the evidence the national tier needs, rather than try to own levers it cannot. A Tourism Growth Steerco at Wesgro CEO level, with DEDAT and Cape Town Tourism, gives the province one voice and one route to national decisions (section 4.7). MIDAS shows the route work this needs: early relationships with Indian carriers and the Indian authorities, and with China's state-owned carriers through the government-to-government process (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, Indian and Chinese Market Opportunity).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco with DEDAT and Cape Town Tourism, and agree a decision-rights map by tier from the Diagnostic's tier table	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism
Wesgro	Hold standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities, with China Southern and China Eastern and with Riyadh Air	Air Access
Wesgro	Track the national capital programmes that bind the plan (runway, ports and rail) and report on them each quarter	Air Access; Research
Partners	Settle district, local and LTO mandates, restore a tourism development function where it has lapsed and revisit the Discover Garden Route partnership	District municipalities; municipalities; LTOs
Partners	Test a dedicated transport authority model for tourism-enabling mobility	Department of Mobility
National	Agree with the province how marketing and data roles divide between national and provincial bodies	SA Tourism; Department of Tourism

Benchmark precedent

Where the benchmark names the body that negotiates air service agreements, it is national: Chile's civil aviation board and Singapore's aviation authority (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23, p38). Valencia embeds municipal, provincial and regional authorities in one decision-making system led by Visit València, and the required change for the Western Cape is to embed tourism governance in permanent public-private structures (p47, p49).

Link forward

Initiative I15, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment, carries this entry with focus area 17 (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-21 escalation items answered by the national tier at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 17

Strengthen industry and government collaboration

Fifteen of the sixteen organisations engaged raised collaboration, and the channels already exist in JAMS, the bid teams and the tour-operator forums, so the task is to turn existing forums into one joint plan.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Strengthen Industry >> Government Collaboration (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64), reprinted from March 2026 as Strengthen Industry > Government Collaboration (Public and Private).

October 2026: Validated. Fifteen of sixteen organisations. The stakeholder theme tally drove the disposition. The count is this report's reconstruction from the appendix tables: it counts organisations with at least one collaboration insight, not insight rows, and the deck prints no tally.

Evidence

Table 3.20. Collaboration is wanted almost everywhere and already works in places, but the forums are marketing-led and the trade's voice is missing.

Finding	Figure	Source
Almost everyone raised it	15 of the 16 organisations raised at least one collaboration insight, 23 rows in all	SIR p20 to p46
A channel exists	Tourism associations already coordinate through JAMS with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town (FEDHASA)	SIR p31
Out of step	Misalignment between public tourism institutions and key industry bodies is weakening collaboration (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p25
Forums are marketing-led	Provincial and regional forums are dominated by destination marketing rather than development, and support is not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39
Joint selling works	Stakeholders collaborate well on bids; 36 conference bids secured in 2024/25 are expected to bring 27,000+ delegates and R745 million by 2028	SIR p46; DSA p36
The trade is missing	No airline, OTA or tour operator took part in the first phase; six demand-side engagements, from Trip.com Group to Emirates, were proposed	SIR p16

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA).

Mossel Bay shows what local collaboration delivers. Its cruise calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season through closer coordination and better excursion packaging, and it credits its public-private tourism model with faster decisions (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20, p21). The province's route record is the larger example: 17 mainline international routes added from 2015 to 2025, which MIDAS attributes to Wesgro's relationship-driven route development (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, Executive Summary and International Comparisons).

Recommendation

Wesgro should use the forums that exist rather than build new ones, and give them a development agenda and a joint plan. JAMS lets consultation cascade across the associations more efficiently than approaching each body

separately (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p31). The Benchmarking Report's model is Valencia's sector councils, where sector-led committees keep development market-driven (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p48, p49).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Use JAMS as the single consultation channel to the associations, and add the Tour Guides Association	Wesgro CEO's office; FEDHASA
Wesgro	Set up sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture inside Steerco's structure	Tourism; Convention Bureau; industry bodies
Wesgro	Run the demand-side engagement round with Trip.com Group, Thomas Cook India, DNATA Travel, China International Travel Service, Emirates and SATSA	Destination Marketing; Air Access
Partners	Supply academic and sector champions for international bids	CTICC; universities
Partners	Give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs	District municipalities; DEDAT; LTOs
National	Include provincial assets in SA Tourism's campaigns for emerging source markets	SA Tourism

Benchmark precedent

Valencia runs sector-led executive committees, with the regional business confederation on its governing board, so that tourism development is market-driven rather than bureaucratically led (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p45, p48). Singapore's tourism board, airport group and national airline work under one coordinated strategy with shared KPIs (p40, p42).

Link forward

Initiative I15, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-22 industry partners signed up to the joint plan at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 18

Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing

No approved method exists for provincial tourism GDP and jobs, operators cannot see their own customers and four arrivals measures run unreconciled, so a data-sharing protocol is the precondition for every target.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Expedite Tourism-Enabling Policy and Data Sharing (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. Already underway. The stakeholder evidence drove the disposition: data and policy is the largest theme in the stakeholder record. The platforms are indeed underway, but no deliverable describes a data-sharing protocol or a policy revision in progress at provincial level [data-sharing protocol or policy revision in progress, with owner and start date: Wesgro Research and DEDAT to confirm].

Evidence

Table 3.21. Data is the largest theme in the stakeholder record, and the gaps run from national methodology to operators' own customer records.

Finding	Figure	Source
The largest theme	15 of 16 organisations and 30 insight rows, the most of any theme, 16 of them rated High	SIR p20 to p46
No provincial method	No approved methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs; official tourism data lag after Covid-era method changes (Department of Tourism)	SIR p37
National capacity is short	Tourism satellite account timeliness is constrained, with 749 Stats SA vacancies cited	SIR p30
No single view	No single view of visitor behaviour; stakeholders collect different metrics at different frequencies with different definitions	Diag p56, p57
Operators cannot see customers	Third-party ticketing channels do not share visitor-level data; Robben Island cannot link marketing spend to visitor acquisition	SIR p36, p33
Platforms exist	JAMS, the provincial tourism statistics committees and a cross-agency task team exist; the Cape Town Tourism and Google collaboration is still exploratory	SIR p29, p30, p31, p37

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag).

The policy side is as thin. The Department of Economic Development reports a provincial tourism policy gap, with limited legislation and out-of-date master-planning frameworks (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25). The Demand-Side Analysis uses four arrivals measures without reconciling them: ACSA passenger arrivals, SA Tourism tourist arrivals, OAG air arrivals and the model's international arrivals (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, p13, p20, p27).

Recommendation

Wesgro should agree a data-sharing protocol with each data holder and run one indicator register and dashboard, as section 5.5 sets out. The Infrastructure Report puts it plainly: a data layer is the prerequisite, without which no intervention can be targeted or measured (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p5). Skift's tracking design is ready to adopt: quarterly digital tracking, annual or twice-yearly brand research and a dashboard that cross-

references campaigns, airline capacity and hotel trends (Skift Digital and Search Insights memo, 10 Dec 2025, section 6).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Agree data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the site operators and the booking platforms	Research
Wesgro	Run one indicator register and dashboard, with quarterly digital tracking and annual brand research	Research; programme office
Wesgro	Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions, and add Nigeria and Ghana to the growth model	Research; Convention Bureau
Partners	Close the provincial tourism policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting	DEDAT; municipalities
Partners	Share visitor-level data from ticketing and reservation systems	Attraction operators; CapeNature
National	Approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA

Benchmark precedent

New Zealand's route-accountable model rests partly on shared data platforms between tourism bodies and airlines, and it recorded more than 16,000 incremental bookings (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p54). Valencia is the realism check: integrating data systems across institutions there created technical and organisational challenges (p45).

Link forward

Initiative I16, data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-23 automated data feeds in the dashboard at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 19

Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits

Visas, air rights, the runway and policing sit with national government, so the province leads by escalation backed with evidence, and delivers the safety programmes and basic services that are its own.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Lead Removal of Infrastructure, Visa and Safety Deficits, under theme 2.1 (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Moved. The entry moved from supply to governance because its levers sit nationally. The stakeholder evidence, the Demand-Side barriers and MIDAS all place visas and air rights with national government; the move itself was decided at the October review [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026: the deck's stated reason for the move to confirm]. The rationale holds for visas and air rights, while safety programmes are a provincial function and basic services a local one (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p58).

Evidence

Table 3.22. The deficits are the best-evidenced barriers in the stakeholder record, and most of the levers sit with national government or SOEs.

Finding	Figure	Source
Raised widely	10 of 16 organisations raised the theme; across all themes, safety perception came from seven organisations, visas from four and utilities from four	SIR p20 to p46
Visas hold back growth markets	Visa issues constrain growth from India and recovery from China; regional African event demand is visa-constrained	SIR p36, p45
Safety is cross-cutting	Perceptions of crime feature in overseas sales conversations; township product and shared mobility are held back by safety perception	SIR p46, p34, p22
Safety and visas top the barriers	Skift's barrier research ranks crime and personal safety first and visa and entry requirements second; e-visa reforms are promising but unproven for the province	Diag p55, p34
The gateway binds	The single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour and relief lands from about 2032; immigration processing at peak needs work	IR p101 to p103; DSA p54
Visa reform moves arrivals	The 2024 Ghana visa waiver drove 36,656 arrivals to South Africa	Skift African, s4.6

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation counts reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Skift, Barriers to visiting Cape Town, 2024, as cited); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026 (working analysis; arrivals to South Africa, not Cape Town).

Inside communities, safety is a launch gate. Nine of the 20 shortlisted communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion, and the Inclusion Plan makes a formal safety assessment a separate requirement before launch (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p30, p35). Congestion costs the Metro an estimated R2.8 billion a year, and water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p38).

Recommendation

Wesgro should run a standing escalation agenda, with each item stated as a decision, the national body that owns it and the date the province asks for, backed by market evidence. The Stakeholder Insights Report's next round already frames that evidence: the access barriers across air, visas and onward travel, and the safety issues most

damaging to demand (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p14). The Diagnostic asks for dedicated tourism safety units and programmes in the Metro (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p41).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Table an escalation agenda at Steerco: visa categories and processing for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements; immigration throughput at Cape Town International	Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT
Wesgro	Build the market-by-market evidence for each ask, from visa processing times to safety perception in source markets	Research; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Carry a visitor-safety narrative in marketing, and apply the four launch gates to any community product Wesgro sells	Destination Marketing; Tourism
Partners	Set up dedicated tourism safety units and programmes, with safety compacts in pilot communities	Western Cape Government; municipalities; SAPS
Partners	Fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns	Municipalities; CapeNature
National	Decide on visa processing, air service agreements and immigration counters, and make station security a rail line item	Home Affairs; Department of Transport; PRASA

Benchmark precedent

Kenya reduces entry friction to position Nairobi as a regional and global hub, and every comparator was scored on ease of access and visas (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p59, p11). The required change for the Western Cape, drawn from Chile, is to lobby actively for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes (p28).

Link forward

Initiative I17, access and safety escalation agenda (section 4.3). **Indicators** T2-24 visa processing time for priority markets and T2-21 escalation items answered at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · FOCUS AREA 20

Develop workforce and service skills

The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition has no baseline and no labour analysis behind it, so the first step is to commission that analysis, and the skills plan follows from it.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. No December entry; skills appear in no printed version of the tree.

October 2026: Flagged, untested. The jobs goal has no labour analysis. The entry was added in October because the 300,000-jobs ambition has no labour analysis behind it, and skills constraints surfaced only as side mentions (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4). As agreed in the report structure, it is written as a recommendation to commission the analysis, not as a finding.

Evidence

Table 3.23. No deliverable carries a provincial tourism employment figure, and the skills evidence is a handful of statements and two training programmes.

Finding	Figure	Source
The ambition has no base	300,000 tourism-linked jobs, one of four headline ambitions, with no base year, baseline or target year	Inc p4
No provincial method	No approved methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates (Department of Tourism)	SIR p37
Skills gaps near reserves	Low baseline skills in communities near reserves need substantial upskilling before service standards can be met (CapeNature)	SIR p43
Municipal capacity is stretched	Local municipalities face skills and staffing constraints, and skills support is not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality)	SIR p39
Training exists in places	20 CATHSSETA site guides certified in Mbekweni in August 2026; a hospitality academy in Prince Albert from early 2026	SCIP p42, p51
One provincial series	1,234 direct cruise jobs in the Western Cape in 2024/25, the only provincial tourism jobs figure in a deliverable	Diag p37

Source: Inception Report, Nov 2025 (Inc); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Western Cape Cruise Liner Industry Economic Contribution 2024/25 Season, as cited). The 2024/25 jobs value equals the 2022/23 GDP value in the same table, so the source study should be checked before the figure is used as a baseline.

Public sources give the scale the analysis must work from: direct tourism employment of 106,707 in Cape Town in 2024 and 953,981 nationally (City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025; Stats SA Tourism Satellite Account, provisional, 2026; public sources). The provincial figure may already be in the project's files, because the Inception Report lists the Western Cape Pero 2025 and the district Mero 2024 among the documents Wesgro supplied (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) [provincial tourism employment from the Pero 2025: Wesgro Research to extract].

Recommendation

Wesgro and DEDAT should commission a tourism labour analysis in 2027. It should fix a provincial employment baseline, test the 300,000 ambition and identify the occupations and skills the growth case needs. Until it reports, Chapter 5 carries jobs as a ratio-based measure on Wesgro's own rule of two jobs per 100

international passengers (section 5.3). The skills plan then runs through the quality charter, where the Benchmarking Report places work-force capability (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Commission the labour analysis with DEDAT: baseline, definition, occupations, skills gaps and the training pipeline	Research; DEDAT
Wesgro	Extract the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025, and obtain the method note for the jobs-per-passenger ratio	Research; Air Access
Wesgro	Build a workforce strand into the provincial quality charter (focus area 11)	Tourism
Partners	Run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, building on the CATHSSETA guide certification and the Prince Albert academy	CapeNature; CATHSSETA; training providers; municipalities
Partners	Help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries	LTOs; tour operators
National	Approve a provincial tourism jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account	Department of Tourism; Stats SA

Benchmark precedent

Singapore's hotel industry transformation map, run by the tourism board with the hotel association and backed by dedicated funds, lifted service quality and spend per visitor (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41). None of the six comparators carries a labour analysis or a tourism employment target, so the sizing step has no precedent in the benchmark set.

Link forward

Initiative I18, tourism labour analysis and skills plan (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-04 tourism jobs at impact level, carried as a ratio-based projection until the analysis reports, and T2-25 labour analysis published at outcome level (section 5.2).

3.4 The integrated case

The three pillars make one case. Demand work fills seats only if the seats exist, supply work pays only if the product can be booked, and both need the enabling base to last.

The growth model sets out three paths from the 2025 base of 1,498,829 arrivals: 1,822,634 in 2035 on the conservative path, 2,175,778 on the base path and 2,516,282 on the accelerated path (Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20). The deck is explicit that the paths differ by intervention, not by demand potential (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19). Each step up the case therefore rests on a set of moves, and the table below maps each set to the focus areas that deliver it.

Table 3.24. Each step of the growth case rests on a named set of interventions, and each set draws on focus areas in all three pillars.

Path	Arrivals in 2035	What the model assumes	Focus areas that deliver it
Conservative	1,822,634	Existing air access held with no added frequencies or routes; continued trade and marketing; growth in the mature markets and current corridors	5 and 7 hold the base
Base	2,175,778 (+353,144)	Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines add frequency and capacity; existing Wesgro programmes expand; India, China and regional Africa grow through hub connections	1 to 7, 9 and 10
Accelerated	2,516,282 (+340,504)	Direct India and China routes secured; dedicated activation in India, China, the USA and the GCC; India, China and the Middle East grow ahead of their source markets	4, 7, 16 and 19, on top of the base

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19 (assumptions) and p20 (2035 end points); Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (2025 base). Increments between paths are computed from the printed end points. The mapping to focus areas is this report's.

The gateway binds first. Current air access places a hard ceiling at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case passes it at the 2030 year point (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21). Relief at Cape Town International arrives about 2032 for the international terminal and about 2033 for the runway (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103). Between those dates, growth has to come from larger aircraft and added frequency on the full routes, from hub-carrier capacity and from George, whose terminal doubles by 2028 (focus areas 5, 6 and 7).

The deck draws arrivals and seats against one axis and prints no seat table behind the 1.8 million line. The crossing year is read from the chart: after the 2028 point (1,673,855) and by the 2030 point (1,802,929).

If the supply moves slip, the case stops at the ceiling. The deck states that the projected growth cannot be realised without additional capacity or frequency (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21), and that without confirmed routes the accelerated case reverts to base (p20). Demand work cannot make up the gap, because marketing into full routes raises fares rather than seats (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, In Conclusion).

Below the gateway, the pillars depend on each other. Green-season demand needs seats in the months carriers now cut (focus areas 2 and 7). Dispersal needs product that can be booked and reached (focus areas 3, 9 and 10). Inclusion needs a seller and a safe visit before exposure (focus areas 13 and 19). Every target needs data that today sits with SA Tourism, ACSA and the booking platforms (focus area 18).

Air access and bookability move first, because every other lever runs through them. The table below sets the order. Chapter 4 turns it into eighteen initiatives with owners, phases and decision gates.

Table 3.25. The first phase works the seats and the booking path before the base case reaches the seat ceiling, and the direct routes wait for runway relief.

Phase	What moves (focus areas)	Why then
Activate, 2027 to 2028	Seats held and added on full routes (5, 6, 7); green-season calendar (2); bookability census and onboarding (3); two or three inclusion pilots (13); Steerco, data protocol and escalation agenda (16, 18, 19); labour analysis commissioned (20)	Before the base case reaches the seat ceiling at the 2030 point
Expand, 2029 to 2031	Hub conversion at scale (4); corridor product and mobility (9, 10); quality charter (11); flagship flow management (12); cruise product (8); investment pipeline at financial close (15)	The 2030 mid-term review tests the ceiling; terminal relief from about 2032
Sustain, 2032 to 2035	Direct India and China routes as runway capacity arrives (4, 7); inclusion scaled after thresholds are met (13); climate risk and LTO funding embedded (14)	Runway relief about 2033; the accelerated case depends on direct routes

Source: Chapter 3 entries 1 to 20; phase years as set in section 4.2; seat ceiling from Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21; airport relief dates from Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103.